8.4 Hygiene and Safety in Food Service

In order to prevent food spoilage in food service following need to be taken care of.

8.4.1 Safe Guarding of Food

Lack of proper attention to handling of food and negligence of personal hygiene lead to food poisoning and require serious attention. The incidence of food borne disease can be considerably reduced by certain healthy practices.

- Cook at high temperature to ensure that all bacteria are killed.
- Keep all perishable foods in a cool place or in refrigerator.
- Cover food to protect from dust, flies and other modes of infection.
- Avoid consuming moldy and foul smelling foods.
- Avoid damaged and bulging tin/ canned foods.
- Wash the foods carefully to ensure the removal of insecticide, worm, eggs, and other parasites sticking to it.
- Keep the utensils free from contamination.
- Ensure food handlers are healthy and free from disease.
- Avoid taking food with dirty fingers.
- Avoid tasting food while cooking.
- Maintain the three 'E's of safety – Engineering, Education and Enforcement.

Food hygiene and sanitation is highly important in food service operations especially in larger scale as they might affect public health. Quality control, microbial safety and good personal hygiene are essential to keep food safe.

8.4.2 Kitchen Hygiene

Hygiene in the kitchen is very important for the general cleanliness of the environment and the people working there as it requires handling of food materials.



▲ Plate 8.15 Hygienic Handling of Food

Table 8.2 Kitchen Hygiene and Sanitation

Environmental Hygiene	Hygienic Food Handling	Personnel Hygiene
Site	Receiving	Neatly Pressed Dress
Structure	Storage	Grooming
Equipment furniture/fittings	Preparation	Health
Ventilation	Cooking	Habits
Lighting	Holding	
Water supply	Serving	
Waste disposal	Cleaning	
	Disposal	

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